



A key aspect of web design; developers need to know configuration well.

Environment Configuration

Various applications run in different types of environment. An environment in the world of web developing means user interface that is being used and the programming interface of an application. It is a bit obvious that it will be a good idea to have varying configuration values depending on the need of the environment. Configuration vary across deploys and as we know, codes do not. This can be done with much ease as Laravel allows the use of environment based configuration.

Laravel have a reputation of making a web developer's life easier. It utilizes the DotEnv PHP library to achieve this. This was developed by Vance Lucas who addressed the issue of configurations in varying environment. When you are installing Laravel fresh, an `.env.example` file will be in your root directory. If you are installing Laravel via composer, this file might need to be manually renamed as `.env` in the event it doesn't happen automatically.

When you've set off to develop your application, you must have a conscientious attitude towards security and exposure to "trade secrets". The risk of intruders gaining access to your source control repository is high when your `.env` file is committed to your source control. This is an easy mistake to make as each server using your application could require a different environment configuration.